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Educational Resources

Education (University of Nairobi)

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IMPORTANCE OF LEARNING RESOURCES IN THE LEARNING PROCESS

- Promotes active learning- learners are involved actively in the lesson
- Makes the learner to enjoy the lesson
- They enhance a lifelong learning
- They develop/stimulate the creativity of the learner/promotes critical and creative thinking
- They motivate and keep learners interested in the learning process
- Strengthens the teacher-learner interaction for effective learning
- Helps to broaden the learning experience thus meeting the learning needs of the learners
- Helps the learner consolidate what has been learnt.
- To focus the attention of the learners.
- To arouse the curiosity of learners.
- To promote retention and memory.
- To simplify difficult concepts.
- To arouse interest in learning.
- To stimulate learners imagination.
- Help to save teaching time especially when the resource is prepared before the lesson/ they help to shorten the explanation by the teacher.
- Provide variety of learning experiences.
- Develop learners' power of observation and reasoning.
- Create good teacher –learner relationship as they are able to interact freely as they manipulate and handle the resources.
- Help to cater for learners individual differences as they are able to appeal to different senses.
- Provide direct or firsthand experience with the realities of the social world.

QUALITIES OF EFFECTIVE LEARNING RESOURCES

- Should have a clear educational purpose
- It should be efficient
- Relevant to the specific learning area
- Should be safe to use
- Meaningful and purposeful
- Accurate
- Simple
- Affordable
- Large enough to be seen by all learners
- Up- to date

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- Easily portable
- Ability to motivate learners
- Colors used to be authentic i.e. resemble the realia
- Titles and headings to be well distributed
-

USES OF LEARNING RESOURCES IN THE LEARNING PROCESS

- To make the learning more comprehensible eg use of realia
- To create a point of contact between the learner and the teacher
- To help students gain experience in the learning process/learning by doing
- To enhance interaction in class thus enhancing sharing of information
- To involve the learner in the teaching process/learner participation
- To simplify information which would otherwise be difficult for the learners
- To make learning more enjoyable e use of visual media
-

EXAMPLES OF LEARNING RESOURCES

Textbooks	pictures
Films/videos	maps
Radio programmes	diagrams
Blackboard	realia-leaves,clay soil
Projector	
Charts	
Cameras	
phones	

THREE DIMENSIONAL RESOURCES (3D)

Realia /Specimen /Real Things

Refers to actual, genuine or authentic materials or specimen, examples are fish, coins, tolls, plants e.t.c.

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Can be used in any subject. Good for use especially where learners have not had an experience with the specimen in their daily life. Learners are able to conceptualize the abstract concepts.

Factors to consider before using realia

How the learners will interact with the realia so as to achieve the learning objective. The teacher must make it clear as to which parts are to be focused on during instruction e.g. the number of legs an animals has.

Find out if the real thing is of good quality. Be accurate with the use of accompanying verbal information like colour, body parts, and shapes in describing the object.

Advantages

- Students become familiar with things in their environment. Students realize inter-relationships between their world activities and realia
- Most real things are easily available and may not be expensive, sometimes they are free.
- Appeal to sense of sight and touch , hence students will remember more.
- Enhances the observational skill of the learners.

Types of Real Things.

- Unmodified real things
- Modified real things

Specimen may be either modified or not where real things are not available the teacher / learners can make models, using wood , cardboard, clay , paper , match sticks , manila paper , sugar paper e.t.c.

<u>Criteria for Rating Models /guidelines</u>

- Consider accuracy, the model must be similar to the real thing.
- Creativity, the information provided must match the level of the learners.
- Quality of the model must be good

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- The model must be durable.
- Colour: to resemble the actual thing.
- Students to resemble the actual thing.
- Students to be allowed to manipulate the model mounting for preserving the models to be considered.

Reasons for creating models

- To enhance the teacher and learners creativity when real things are not available when needed.
- Some realia are either too big or too small or even dangerous to use, others may be too costly to buy while others too complex for learners to understand.

Examples of Modified Models

- Human skull, can be separate, rearrange and coloured.
- Human skeleton could be in full parts.
- Mechanical devices can be cut away in sections to permit observation of hidden parts.
- Oil refinery, make a mock one to simplify, the essential operations.

Examples of Modified Real Things.

Diorama

Is a static display which consists of 3 dimensional foreground and flat background. The foreground is usually a landscape of some sort with models of people, animals, equipment and buildings. The naturalistic background may be photograph, drawing or painting to give it a naturalistic look.

The setting enable contained in a box such sides of the box can be used for depth to reinforce the natural look.

Use of Diorama

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- To reproduce reality of the past or present events and predict future events e.g battle scenes.
- To provide a visual map of an area e.g a school, industry, administration block e.t.c
- To show production process, distribution and use of products e.g Kenya Pipeline.
- In geography, town , landscapes and water points can be shown also soil profile
- In history, prehistoric landscapes can be shown to summarize a unit of study.

Materials to use.

- Tree branches, trees to represent reality
- Shoe boxes, cardboard.
- Sawdust to represent dry vegetation.
- Clay to make animals
- Cards / labels to explain details.

AUDIO-VISUAL RESOURCES

These are resources which combine both pictures and sound to pass information

Examples films, videos, computer, television, smart phone, slides presentation

IMPORTANCE

- Makes learning interesting
- Helps the learner to store information for future reference eg computer and phone
- Information is well retained because learners easily remember what they see and hear more than what they read because they use more than one sence.
- Allows the teacher to engage the learners in the learning process
- Helps to highlight key points and reinforce them at the same time
- Helps to clarify points giving the learners a better understanding
- They help to avoid excessive verbalization while teaching
- They help students to make clear mental pictures of what they are learning
- Helps to teach new and abstract concepts which may be difficult to grasp

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- Helps to cater for learners differences in class ie inclusive learning where learners with hearing impairment and visual impairment can learn comfortably in class

MERITS OF AUDIO VISUAL RESOURCES

- Helps to make learning process more effective and conceptual
- Helps to grab the attention of students
- Builds interest and motivation of students during learning
- Makes learning easier in a populated class
- It provides learners with a realistic approach of learning
- Helps to cater for different learners differences/ inclusive learning
- Helps to reach many learners at a go

DEMERITS

- Technical problems
- Students distractions ie they may use the resources for non-educational purposes
- They are expensive to buy and maintain
- Power irregularities which may disrupt learning
- They may be time consuming making they less effective
- Things like computers and phones may suffer from virus threat
- They also need space to store eg computers

LEARNERS LIKELY TO BENEFIT FROM USING AUDIO VISUALS IN TEACHING

Those with

- ✓ Language disorder
- ✓ Autism
- ✓ Down syndrome
- ✓ Personality development delay
- ✓ Hearing impairment
- ✓ Visual impairment

TELEVISION (AUDIO VISUAL)

The television (TV) is an electronic device that transmits still and moving pictures with .accompanying sound, through wires and space. There arc two types of televisions. They are:

- **Open circuit -** This is the usual telecast device used by home viewers. Here, programmes are commercially sponsored and purposely produced for viewing.

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- **Closed circuit -** This sends specifically designed signals tor classroom instruction purposes and, therefore, interests educators and learners only, for example, microteaching skills.

In order to prepare for and make use of television broadcasts effectively, the teacher should:

- Study the broadcast manual to understand and explain any difficult concepts and words that will be used in the programme to the learners.
- Prepare discussion questions and learning resources to use before, during and after the programme.
- Explain the objectives of watching the TV broadcast to the learners.
- Provide comfortable viewing conditions for example, no glare in the room and j noiseless environment.
- Have elementary knowledge of the control of the TV set so as to be able to adjust it when in use.

Prepare follow-up activities.

- The teacher could also ask the school to buy specially taped educational video cassettes, compact discs (CDs) and video compact discs (VCDs) from the department of Media Services at KIE and a video cassette player to enable the learners to view such programmes at their own convenience.

Advantages of using the television

- It avails information for all who can access the television programmes..
- Images are three-dimensional and this makes the experience life-like.
- It can be used in combination with other, teaching and learning resources.
- When used together with video tapes, VCDs and DVDs, the learners are able to access historical information, events and places.
- It saves time as the teacher gives brief explanations.
- What is learnt is retained for a long time and it involves two senses, hearing and sight.

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Disadvantages of using the television

- Learners may become passive.
- Learning becomes impersonal as the teacher cannot receive feedback from learners.
- Scheduling may be a challenge because timing of broadcasts may not be flexible
- It does not cater tor learners' individual differences.
- Power failure may cause interruptions during the TV broadcast.
- Some schools may not afford to buy TV sets.\
- Signal reception may present a problem, especially in remote areas.
- Learners' previous experience and mastery of language may limit their understanding of the programme

How to get most from Television.

- It is expensive for some schools.
- There is poor reception in some parts of the country. Therefore, there is need for more satellites to be set up.
- Some programmes fall during wrong hours either when the students are occupied or when the teacher is not available ; to organize the entire class for viewing
- It is difficult to sieve out important information from a programme designed for a different purpose and addressed to a different audience (public).

FILMS

The teacher is encouraged to identify relevant films for use .some of the places where films can be sourced are , British council library, National museums ,American council centre ,K.I.C.D, Kenya national library, Kenya national archives among others.

LIMITATIONS OF FILMS.

- Some can give incorrect notions.
- At times learners treat films as entertainment.
- Films may emphasise elements that should not be emphasized.
- It difficult to skip what is irrelevant.

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- Require special provision for projection.
- Take up a lot of time, thought and money.
- Sometimes the language used is not to the level of learners.
- Not suitable for learners with visual and hearing impairments.

PROCEDURE FOR SHOWING THE FILM

- Prepare yourself
    - Select a film related to the study
    - Pay careful attention to the recommended level of use.
    - Check the equipment to ascertain that its in good condition
    - Plan how it is going to be used
    - Use the film guides.
- Prepare the classroom
    - Place the title, new vocabulary, and main points or questions on the chalkboard.
    - Set up the equipment, thread
    - Check sitting position of learners, the screen and ventilation.
- Prepare the learners
    - Introduce the film and tell them why they are viewing it.
    - Display support material if any.
    - Explain the new words
    - Identify the learners activities
    - Identify the main points they should look for in the film.
    - Let students note down the questions to be answered as they watch the film.
    - Give them a study guide if need be
- Present the film
    - When everything is ready, maintain silence and start the film.

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- Focus and frame the film
- Check sound level
- Watch the film failure due to damages.
- Do not make comments while the film is running
- If need arises stop the film and give comments.

➢ Follow up

- Ask learners questions about the film.
- Discuss the main features of the film
- Initiate creative followup activities e.g written work, tests, projects ,reading on the topic , report e.t.c
- If necessary show he film once more.

GUIDELINES FOR THE USE OF AUDIO-VISUAL LEARNING RESOURCES

- Use a resource for the right purpose
- Choose a good quality of the resources
- Consider time allocated for the lesson
- Use resources suitable for the Age and ability of the learners
- Teacher should be able to use the resource effectively
- Consider the cost of buying and maintaining before settling on what resource to use
- Keep resources in a safe place after use
- Prepare a resource earlier enough before the start of the lesson
- They should be feasible
- They should suit the learning objectives
- The nature of subject being taught

- Relevancy
- Useful and purposeful teaching
- Accuracy
- Interest
- Minimize verbalism
- Comprehensibility
- Motivation
- Realism

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AUDIO RESOURCES

IMPORTANCE OF AUDIO RESOURCES

- ✓ **Listening to content can also provide a social component to learning that may be lacking when using text-only materials.** While students reading silently at their own pace has its own benefits, listening opens up the possibility of laughing or gasping in surprise together as a group, turning the material into a shared learning journey rather than a more solitary endeavor.
- ✓ **Audio can be useful in introducing students to vocabulary above their reading level.** Students who are still working on decoding or who are learning English may not be able to read beyond a certain level, but that doesn't necessarily mean they are not ready for more advanced vocabulary or to dive in to content that is otherwise more advanced than their current reading level.
- ✓ Students who listen to audio may well have a different emotional reaction or otherwise relate to content delivered via audio differently than if the same material were presented as text.
- ✓ Better classroom management: **Enhanced audio can cause less stress in the classroom and fewer discipline issues**.
- ✓ **helps the teacher to present the lesson effectively and students learn and retain the concepts better and for longer duration**
- ✓ Use of audio visual aids improves student's critical and analytical thinking
- ✓ Audios make the learning process interesting.

MERITS OF AUDIO RESOURCES

- Inexpensive. All of the audio/voice technologies are relatively inexpensive.
- Easily accessible. Almost every home in the United States has a telephone. ...
- Easy to use. Almost everyone is comfortable using a telephone and an audio cassette.
- Using music and mnemonics as audio aids in teaching has also been proven to help students with memorization
- When efficiently used, they can be used to reach many people
- Audios capture the attention of learners in class

PRINCIPLES IN THE USE OF AUDIO-VISUAL AIDS

- Audio-visual materials should-function as an integral parts of the educational programmes.
- Audio-visual and should be centralized, under specialized. direction and leadership in educational programmes.
- An advisory committee should be appointed to assisted in the selection and co-ordination of audio-visual material

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- Audio-visual educational programmes should be feasible..
- Instructors have to help the students how to use audio-visual aids.
- Budget approximations should be made regularly for the audio-visual educations programme.
- Legal aspects should be considered in the production and the utilization of educational communication media.

1.Principle Of Select
1.Audio-visual aid should suit
-The teaching objective.
-Unique characteristics of the special group of learners.
-The age level.
-Grade level etc.
2.Special educational value and stimulate interest and motivation.
3.True representatives of the real things
4. Help in the realization of desires, learning objective.
2.Principle Of Preparation:
1.Deals with a cost effective ways of preparing aids
2.Localy available material aids
3.Students should be associated in preparation of Audio-visual aids.
3.Principle Of Proper Presentation:
Their principle suggests the following points for the effective use of an aid
1.The instructional programme should be so organized and administered that the AV-aids material must function as an integral part of the teaching activity, teacher have to plan well in advance.
2.Visual instruction in the classroom should not be confused with entertainment.
3. Teacher should check the adequacy or working condition of an aid before using it so that she can conduct teaching properly.
4.Teacher should be confident in handling the aid.
5.Adequate aid should be displayed properly so that all students are able to see it, observe it and derive maximum benefit out of it.
6.Adequate care should be taken while handling the aid inorder to prevent any damage.
7.As far as possible, distraction of all kinds should be avoided so that full attention may be paid to the aid.
4.Principle Of Physical Control:or handling
The principle is related to the arrangement of keeping aids safely and also to facilitate their lending to the teacher for use.
5.Principle Of Response:
The principle demands that the teachers have to guide the students to respond actively to the audio-visual stimuli so that they can achieve learning objective in a better way.
6.Audio-Visual Aids Are Means To An End, Not The End In Themselves:

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Disadvantages

- May present difficulties in accessing or selecting specific segments
- May be time consuming in terms of preparation and time spent learning new technologies
- The pace of the recited material may not be appropriate for all students as these often have varying experiential backgrounds and attention span ranges
- Audio-based learning is difficult for people with a hearing disability.
- Creating audio is extra work for an instructor.
- audio is often best used in conjunction with other media such as text or graphics thus adding complexity to the design of teaching.
- They are not interactive,makes the students passive
- They do not provide the visual elements that many students desire.
- Learners may not be listening to the material/ their minds may not be in class

GUIDELINES FOR THE USE OF AUDIO RESOURCES

PRINCIPLES OF USING TEACHING AND LEARNING RESOURCES./Guidelines

1. Prepare yourself by knowing the resources and deciding on when and how to use it.
2. Prepare the materials by putting them in order for easy use and test them before the lessons begin.
3. The environment should be conducive to the experience you have planned for the learners.
4. Prepare the learners by guiding them to respond to stimuli. This is also known as the principal of response.
5. The material should be introduced by the teacher in a manner that strikes the attention of learners. Ensure its accompanied with sufficient explanations ,comments ,and demonstrations. The material should be viewed by all the learners with ease.
6. The teacher should continuously evaluate the material to ascertain that the desired outcome has been achieved.

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USES OF AUDIO LEARNING RESOURCES

learning resources choosing a radio programme should check on the following

- **Objectives :** The objectives of the lesson should be clear, measurable, attainable and appropriate for the intended level
- **Content**: The content should be relevant to particular objectives, adequate in terms of content coverage, accurate and appropriate to the level of the learners. It should also be available to the learners and up-to-date.
- **Authenticity:** The programme producers should be qualified in the field and should demonstrate competence.
- **Organization of the script**: The content should be well-organized and accompanied by appropriate support materials. It should also be convenient to follow in classroom use.
- **Sound and Voice Quality:** The sound and voice should be audible to the entire class, clear and fluent. The pronunciation should be good.
- **Presentation**: This should involve a good introduction, logical lesson development and a conclusion. The conclusion can be a summary of the main points of the lesson or questions on the content covered.
- **Learners' involvement:** This should be reflected in the learning activities which should be appropriate and challenging enough for the intended class level.
- **Follow-up:** The follow up should be in form of assignments e.g. project work, written questions, library work etc.

Preparation for a radio lesson

- Get in advance details of the programme to be broadcast.
- Select the programmes that have positive value for your students.
- Judge how to make the best use of each programme you have selected, whether live, recorded in full or in part.
- Make whatever administrative preparation are necessary to obtain the equipment and accommodation needed for the lesson.

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- Prepare the students before the broadcast in accordance with any suggestions contained in the printed teachers' notes.
- Plan timing and physical arrangements so that the students receive the programmes clearly.
- Carry out whatever follow-up is necessary to derive full benefit from the programme

How to conduct a radio lesson

When conducting a radio lesson, you should:

- Prepare the learners for the lesson. This can be done by introducing the topic and informing the learners of what is expected of them during and after the lesson, e.g. they should be told to be attentive, to write new terms and concepts, to make notes, to follow instructions given by the radio teacher.
- Tune the radio before the lesson begins to ascertain that the volume is high enough for all to hear (this should be tested before the teacher goes to the classroom)
- ensure good sitting/seating arrangement;
- Display the necessary instructional materials before the lesson starts:
- Place the radio at a strategic place in the class to enable learners to hear without straining.

- turn on the radio at the right time (when the lesson is beginning)
- turn on the right volume;
- listen and obey instructions of the radio teacher and
- Make a follow-up to the lesson by organizing discussion, asking the learners questions, or giving a related assignment.

Advantages of using the radio

The radio is important in teaching because of these reasons;

- It motivates the learners to learn by providing a variety of voices, e.g. radio teacher, radio students, thus breaking the classroom monotony.
- It has power to stimulate the learners' imaginative ability.

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- It provides learners with recent information not available in books.
- It provides for individual learning and independence in cases where the learners listen to the radio programmes during their free time.
- It improves learners' listening skill which is important in any learning process.
- Radio programme can be tape-recorded and preserved for future use.

THE TAPE RECORDER

A tape recorder could be defined as a device used to record speech, music e.t.c on electromagnetic tape.

- Interviews
- Speeches
- Debates

How to use a tape recorder in the classroom

For effective utilization of the tape recorder, you should follow the following steps:

- Interviews
- Speeches
- Debates

How to use a tape recorder in the classroom

For effective utilization of the tape recorder, you should follow the following steps:

- Preview the audio material

  The teacher has to listen to the material critically before taking it to the classroom. This will help to:
- Determine the relevancy of the material
- Find out the objectives of the audio material
- Identify important terms and concepts used.
- Find out other materials required for the lesson, e.g. maps, charts and pictures.

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- Find out whether there are activities for the students during the lesson.
- Know the duration of the programme so that the teacher could make the necessary adjustment regarding the lesson.(timetable).
- Decide on how the material will be presented, i.e. whether it will be a continuous play or there will be pauses to allow for questions and discussion
- Decide on assessment procedures to use to determine whether the objectives have been realized. .
- Test on the condition of the cassette and on the cells (in places with no electricity) whether they are low or high.

Prepare the class for listening:

- Introduce the programme to the students and explain the objectives;
- Write new terms and concepts on the chalkboard and explain them:
- Inform the learners what is expected of them during the lesson e.g. making notes, writing down the main points, etc.
- Reorganize seating/sitting arrangement if need be;
- emphasize on class control;
- Encourage students to listen quietly and carefully.

Play the programme

- Place the player in a strategic place.
- Turn on the player and make sure the volume is loud enough for the whole class.
- Stop and replay where necessary.
- Ensure that the learners are doing the right thing at the right time during the programme. This is to ensure full participation, e.g. making notes and answering questions.

Follow-up activity

As a part of follow-up of the programme the teacher should do the following:

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- Fill in gaps where there were omission in the presentation.
- Make clarification on area which was not clear to the learners.
- Invite questions/comments from the students about the programme.
- Ask questions to find out whether the learner understood the lesson.
- Give assignment to the learners, e.g. to write notes, work on a project, to draw a chart, to role play, to write a test.
- Evaluate the effectiveness of the programmes by assessing learners performance in the given assignments.

Limitations of using a tape recorder

A tape recorder has a number of disadvantages as a resource of teaching history:

- The recorded programme lacks the visual image which is very necessary in the teaching of history.
- The programme does not cater for individual differences.
- Communication is usually one-way from" the presenter to the audience and not vice-versal
- Sometimes tape recorders are used to substitute the teacher although this should not be the case as the teacher is expected to guide the learners throughout the programme.
- Effectiveness of using the tape recorder depends on the listening skills of the learners, something which is beyond the teacher's control as one cannot ascertain that the learners are really listening.
- It is not effective in large classes as the sound may not reach all the students.
- Not every school can afford to buy the machine and its accompaniments.

GRAPHIC LEARNING RESOURCES

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GRAPHICS (They use combination of drawings, words, pictures and symbols.)

They are also referred to as non –projected media. They include , chalkboards, diagrams ,charts, atlas ,maps, pictures, bulletins,globe, and magnetic boards

Importance of graphic learning resources

- They convey ideas through simple, bold, legible, brief, non-verbal experiences during teaching learning process. –
- They facilitate the formation of mental images so basic to learning
- . They convey certain types of information in a condensed and summarized form.
- They help readers and students better understand the topic through visualization
- Students may have trouble grasping key concepts in class lectures—**graphics can aid in understanding them**
- . Sometimes ideas under discussion are complex—graphics can help illustrate them.
- Some processes take extensive amounts of text to describe—images may be able to convey them better.
- They create interest and motivation to learn
- They make learning interesting and fun

ADVANTAGES OF GRAPHIC RESOURSES IN LEARNING

- Can present summaries of information.
- Can be easily made by students. ...
- Can be moved with ease from one place to another.
- They attract the attention of the learners
- The simplify complex information
- Direct learners' attention when it is needed most, e.g. in introduction for a good effective and at the end for forceful conclusion.
- Motivates learners by providing a variety of media.
- Summarize information through the use of figures, statistics and symbols.
- Transforms abstract ideals in visual form.
- Stimulates creative thinking

Disadvantages of graphic materials

- Some like charts cannot show motion.
- They can be cumbersome to handle according to the number of students in a class
- They can be outdated
- They may not be stored for future use because of the materials used to make them.
- They may be expensive to make or buy
- Data may be a false representation of the actual data
- Do not cater for individual differences in learners

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- Are small hence not ideal for a large class.
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How to Use Graphics To Improve Learning

- **Represent Geography and Statistical Data** Maps are ideal for helping learners understand location and geography, but they can be used for more than this. Consider using statistical maps to show quantitative information. Statistical maps show the distribution of a variable as it relates to location
- **Portray Emotions in Stories**

  When you use a scenario approach to learning, use photographs or illustrations to ensure the audience gets the message. Showing the characters as they experience an event adds emotional depth.
- **Visualize Data as a Cognitive Aid** Diagrams and graphs help learners comprehend large sets of data using visual language to depict meaning. For example, it's easier to make comparisons when looking at a bar chart than when looking at raw numbers. In diagrams the connecting lines between elements help learners understand relationships. Line graphs help learners understand trends.
- **Identify Parts and Components** Use labeled illustrations when a learner needs to know the specific parts of an object. This is particularly useful when there are many components, such as in anatomical or mechanical illustrations and diagrams.
- **Trace the Motion and Path of an Object** You can also depict motion with curved arrows, such as showing the moving parts of a machine. Wavy arrows can also depict movement, such as evaporation in the water cycle.
- **Envision Metaphors and Analogies**

  In instructional design, it is helpful to use a metaphor or analogy to explain something unfamiliar by comparing it with a familiar object or idea. Metaphors offer an excellent opportunity for using visuals, because they work well as mnemonic devices—helping learners to remember new information.

GUIDELINES ON THE USE GRAPHIC MATERIALS

- Use graphics to supplement or clarify information provided within the body of your report.
- Make sure your graphics are appropriate to your audience, subject matter, and purpose.
- Discuss graphics in nearby text preceding the graphic. Don't just insert a graphic in your presentation unexplained. Orient readers to the graphic; explain its basic meaning, easily done in introductory and follow-up sentences before and after your graphic.

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- Intersperse graphics and text on the same page. Don't put graphics on pages by themselves; ideally, no visual should take up more than one-third of any page in your report.
- Use figure numbers and titles for graphics. Additionally, include identifying detail within the graphics such as illustration labels, axis labels, keys, and so on.
- Make sure graphics fit within normal margins. Leave at least one blank line above and below graphics.

USES OF GRAPHIC MATERIALS

CHARTS

A chart is a combination of written or drawn pictorial or graphic material which presents a clear visual summary in tabulated or methodical form. Charts are either teacher -made or ready –made (commercially obtained). Where possible it is recommended that teachers make their own charts incorporating their personal ideas and lines of approach in communication. If possible the teacher should involve the students in preparation of charts.

Examples of charts used are, pie charts, graphs, pictorial charts, diagrams, time lines and line charts.

USE OF CHARTS

Charts can be used to:

1. Direct learners' attention when it is needed most, e.g. in introduction for a good effective and at the end for forceful conclusion.
2. Motivates learners by providing a variety of media.
3. Summarize information through the use of figures, statistics and symbols.
4. Transforms abstract ideals in visual form.
5. Stimulate creative thinking.

QUALITIES OF A GOOD CHART

A good chart must:

1. Have a heading/titles in capital letters.
2. Bring out the message clearly precisely and forcefully i.e. it should have a central ideal standing out clearly.
3. Use the symbols which can be understood by the users.
4. Contain information which is true, accurate and authentic in all respects.
5. Be simple, not loaded with unnecessary details.
6. Have bold writings and outlines which can be clearly seen from a distance.
7. Be easy to read with clear symbols and lettering.
8. Be interesting and neat, making it attractive to loot at.
9. Be of good size, large enough to be seen by the entire class.
10. Make use of conventional colors where necessary and also color coding to show contrast, comparisons or growth.

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HOW TO PREPARE CHART

When preparing charts for teaching/ learning purposes, the teacher should do the following:

1. Use a manila paper which allows for the use of all conventional colors, white is an ideal color.
2. Give the chart a heading written in capital letters which is brief and clear.
3. Give I ta frame which has margin with two opposite sides which are proportional.
4. Sketch out the outline of the chart on a manila paper with a pencil.
5. Pencil in details of the chart lightly.
6. Ink the outline and details in the chart.
7. Where possible use a lettering guide.
8. Give a chart a key at the right bottom corner. The key should tell exactly what each symbol represents.
9. Keep it in good condition before use and after use.

HOW TO USE IT

Using the chart following should be done:

1. Give a provision for handing or pinning the chart at a strategic place in the classroom. Do not use the learners to hold it unless it cannot be helped.
2. Use proper material for displaying the chart without damaging it e.g cellotapes, a string for hanging, pins, staples.
3. Display it when you are ready to use it i.e. it should be introduced at the right time.
4. At times prepare questions which could be answered using the chart.
5. Make maximum use of the chart during the lesson.
6. Use a pointer to point out specific features in the chart. Once the class is through with the chart it should be removed.
7. Store and preserve it for future use.

PICTURES

There are a wide variety of pictures which could be used in teaching. They could be obtained from textbooks, reference books, religious pictures books, postcards, newspapers, magazines or they could be taken alive by camera person as events take place e.t.c.

Criteria for good pictures

A picture selected, must be:

- Truthful and accurate, portraying the events of discussion truthfully.
- Clear and easy to understand with important parts of the picture standing out clearly.

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- Interesting, attractive in its artistic form and color leading to the stimulation of the mind.
- Clean and in good condition.
- Suitable for a particular purpose. The teacher has to be clear on the point of the picture is supposed to illustrate the lesson.
- Visible: it should be large enough and easily visible to the entire class.
- Relevant and useful: a picture must have some educational value making an important contribution to the lesson
- Pleasing and harmonious: it must have original colours accurately and vividly reproduced.
- Artistically and technically of high quality.

How to utilize pictures

In order to promote maximum learning, pictures should be selected and used in accordance with sound guidance:

1. The teacher should prepare questions in advance which will guide learners into interpreting pictures so that they are directed or challenged by their observation.
2. The teachers should guide the learners to ensure that they not only look at the pictures but also look into them, criticize, interpret and explain their significance.
3. Select and arrange pictures carefully to for a sequence so that significant questions can be raised as the learners examine them.
4. Loose and large pictures should be displayed at a strategic point in the classroom for every leaner to see.
5. Small pictures should be projected so that the entire class can see them.
6. Provide pictures for individual, small groups and whole class to study.
7. Avoid passing pictures.
8. Use few pictures at a time; holding back pictures on topics which will rise later in the lesson(s). such a procedure moves learners from one lesson to another.
9. Use labels and captions, coloured paper, arrows and strips (in drawn pictures)to highlight items in pictures, this will add to the instructional value of pictures through improvising eye appeal.
10. Organize picture collection around main ideas or problems and place them in a kit or file for easy handling and utilization.
11. Pictures can also be mounted to add to their attractiveness and durability.
12. Picture on display should be changed frequently because after sometime they will lose their motivational appeal.
13. Keep pictures clean and not tattered. Transparent plastic papers can be used to preserve them for future use.

MAPS

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A map is a representation, usually on a flat surface, of the feature of an area of the earth.

Qualities of a good map

1. It should have a title.
2. Should be up-to-date and relevant to the topic.
3. Should be simple and not detailed.
4. It should be clearly labeled.
5. It should be attractive to the users.
6. Learners should be able to see them from all the parts of their class.
7. Should be framed.
8. Should have symbols.
9. Should contain the most recent shape and details.
10. Should be durable.

How to use maps

1. Hang it conveniently in front of the class.
2. Display it at the appropriate time.
3. Draw attention of all learners to it.
4. Use a pointer to attract the attention to various features on the map.
5. Identify the questions to answered by learners from it in advance.
6. Inform the learners how on what to observe from the map.
7. Stress the relationship rather than mere location if the aim is to locate a certain area.
8. Relate map work with the learners experiences for example start from familiar things before you discuss unfamiliar content.
9. Guide the learners in developing skills such as observation, interpretation and location.
10. Encourage the learners to practice drawing maps.
11. Handle maps well and keep them safely after use.

Importance of maps

1. Makes facts to be understood easily by the learners.
2. Learners are able to visualize areas in questions and relative position of political units of people's relationship with their environment.
3. Learners are able to remember what is being learnt with a lot of ease.
4. Makes learning concepts to be real, adequate and complete to the leaners.
5. Motivates the learners.

Types of maps

There are five types of maps used in teaching;

1. Sketch maps

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2. Atlas maps
3. Wall maps
4. Topographical maps
5. Globes

1 **Sketch maps**

These are maps which can be drawn by the teacher and the learners. They are not drawn to scale although they should have all other marginal information found in other maps. sketch maps can be drawn on the chalkboard, manila or sugar paper. A good sketch map should be large, accurate, clear, appropriate and relevant to the instructional objectives.

2 Atlas maps

These are found in special books produced by publishers. the maps are drawn to a small scale to enable them cover large areas. Atlas maps use more conventional symbols that are not indicated in the key.

Advantages of atlas maps

- Useful in studying distant areas in a general way.
- Specialized atlases enable learners to get in-depth information.
- Enables learners to get new or additional information to what is found from books, the teacher or the source.
- Can be easily bought from bookshop.

Limitations

1. Are expensive
2. Do not cater for diverse learner differences.
3. May at times not have specific information required.

GLOBE

This is a three dimensional representation of the earth in a spherical model.A globe provides the true idea of the total environment at a glance in a classroom setting.

- Can be used to explain the shape of the earth.
- The rotation and revolution of earth.
- Location of places using latitudes and longitudes.
- Systems of wind systems of the earth.
- To show the shape and size of areas.
- To show the shortest routes between countries.
- To explain day and night seasons.
- To explain the developments that are common in the world.

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- To explain large and remote areas in a more concrete form.

  LIMITATIONS
- Are expensive to purchase.
- If improvised by the teacher they take a lot of instruction time.
- Do not cater for individual differences in learners
- Are small hence not ideal for a large class.

•

PRINT MEDIA

Print materials are items such as books, pamphlets, newspapers and periodicals.

IMPORTANCE OF PRINT MEDIA IN THE LEARNING PROCESS

- They provide a rounded education in that they cover all the learning areas in the curriculum and much more;
- They contain news and features on politics, sport, consumer issues, education, business, the weather, advertising, environmental details, community issues and so on;
- They entertain and inform at the same time and the activity method which is used promotes learner participation;
- They are the only "textbooks" that are completely consumable instructional tools
- They offer valuable and up to date information. This especially the case with the newspaper and the weekly/monthly magazines. The recency of the information makes teaching more real and applicable to the students' environment
- they are available in the open market in a wide variety ,hence one can get a better balanced view of issues discussed in various sources
- Occasionally ,they offer very detailed information otherwise not available in ordinary text books ,e.g during anniversaries, newspapers may outline achievements of given organizations in various fields. Newspapers have been found to be very usefull during national days in highlighting the nation's development. In them ,we also find concepts like trade ,interdependence, neocolonialism, urbanization,structural adjustments and developments etc
- they are flexible in their use e.g magazines and newspapers can be cut into relevant pieces to illustrate or to convey a message or they can be used whole on a wide range of topics
- They help in the development of :
- reporting information accurately and systematically
- comparing information from different sources to arrive at a reasonable conclusion
- Identifying some concepts commonly associated with history or any other subject
- Newspapers and reviews can provide a room for open criticism and suggestions on local problems like land clashes, ethnicity, national unity, civil wars and environmental issues

How to use print materials in teaching and learning. Guidelines or principles

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- Read and digest the material to determine what would be useful to the learners
- Chose what is relevant and accurate in relation to the topic
- Evaluate the appropriateness of the vocabulary for the grade level of learners or the class
- Determine whether additional information is needed to support the existing materials
- Prepare relevant notes to focus the learners attention.
- Prepare questions to enable learners know exactly what they are required to extract from the readings
- Evaluate learners' answers to determine which areas need further attention.

Advantages

- It is extremely portable
- cost effective,
- readily available
- Students don't need special equipment to use it
- print materials can be used anywhere at any time.
- Students can review the materials at their own speed.
- They keep learners updated on day today happenings
-

Disadvantages

- They lack objectivity because most of the information is influenced by personal or group interests.
- They are not durable and can easily be destroyed if not handled well
- Magazines and newspapers give emphasis to immediate news so they may not be reliable
- Some print materials e.g journals do not report daily events and so they are not up to date
- Some are expensive and this limits readership e.g. , journals and magazines

- No interactions. Print materials do not generally provide built-in interactions. ...
- No audio/visual elements. Print materials are static and are not appropriate for teaching languages and visual concepts.
- Require reading skills

TEXT BOOKS

A text book can be defined as a standard book especially designed to teach a specific body of knowledge to a specific group of learners.

Text Books are important because:

- They spell out and interpret the syllabus.

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- They provide a uniform selected and an organized body of knowledge that can be used as a basis for determining course content and area of emphasis.
- They enable one to skim an account, something one cannot easily do with a film, a Television or radio programme, thus making read to read what interests them.
- they assist the teacher in daily lesson preparation, in giving assignment and providing further readings to the learners' thus reinforcing learning.
- They enable the teacher to organize class activities during and after the lesson.

Criteria for a good text book.

- The textbook should be relevant to curriculum objectives.
- It should have relevant and accurate information.
- It should have maximum content coverage as per syllabus that is free from bias, controversy and with concepts explained clearly with sufficient details.
- . It must be properly arranged with an information table of contents, glossary, complete and detailed index and bibliography, which are important for all ages of students.
- Subject matter should be divided in proper chapters or units following a chronological order making it easier for classroom use. It must also have headings and summaries.
- The language used should be suitable in relation to the class to be taught.
- It should be an attractive and stimulating book including devices that aid past learning such as illustrations and maps to avoid monotony of prints.
- The print should be clear and easy to read, the typeface pleasing with enough spacing between words, line and paragraphs.
- It must provide a variety of thought-provoking activities and exercises for the learners at the end of each chapter.

Effective utilization of the Textbook

- Familiarize yourself within the textbook and supplement textbook information with material from other books and sources. After identifying a topic covered in the textbook, the reader should read it, and look for a similar topic in other history-resources available in the library or in the school.
- Re arrange the order of topics if you thinks it is desirable adapting it to the learners and their needs.
- Use only those parts of the text that seem to be relevant. Skip the other parts.
- Use the textbook for reference purposes during a lesson or a series of lessons.
- Study pictures, maps, diagrams, sketches and particular passages and build lessons around them. They can form a basis for class discussion.

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- Use the textbook when you want to develop critical thinking by encouraging critical reading and testing for logic, and bias.
- Use the textbook when discussing controversial issues
- Use it to explain unfamiliar historical terms.
- Use it to develop writing styles e.g. writing of peoples' biographies and autobiographies.
- Incorporate the textbook into multi-media teaching strategy i.e. use it with other materials and methods.
- Use assignments in the textbook as follow-up activities after the lesson considering different abilities of the learners.
- Use it as a source of structure when planning to teach and encourage students

Limitations of textbooks

Textbooks have the following shortcomings:

- Some of them provide sketchy information and this disadvantages readers who sorely depend on them.
- When overused they replace the teacher in the classroom.
- Textbooks predigest material and so denies the learners the need to think, to do their own organizing and arrive at independent conclusions.
- They encourage rote learning.
- Sometimes the textbooks represent the views of the author or government of the day thus indoctrinating the learners.
- Textbooks are pre-planned and do not meet the varied abilities of a typical class. The class members usually move together as if they are of the same ability thus ignoring individual differences. They treat too many topics, present too many ideas too fast to be absorbed within a given period of time. It does not matter whether the learners have understood or not.
- Textbooks are usually not written in readable form. Rarely do learners comment on the excitement and vigour of a textbook as they might on the qualities of a motion picture or a recording.
- Textbooks are hard to keep up-to-date. In some topics the material is out of date by the time the book appears in the market and it takes time before it is revised.
-
-

ASSINGMENT ; Write notes on the uses of various print resources used in the learning process

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DISPLAY BOARDS

Examples of display boards;

Bulleting boards

Whiteboard

Magnetic board

Blackboard

Importance of display boards

- To catch the viewer's attention and explain what was performed and what was learned.
- Increased Interaction & Collaboration.
- . By displaying some of the best students works on the classroom display board, other students tend to be motivated and set a goal.

advantages

- Better Student Engagement..
- Enhanced Support for All Learning Styles. ...
- Good to give feedback
- Good classroom Management. ...
- They are easy to use
-

CHALKBOARD LAYOUT

➢ Additional information ➢ New words ➢ Correct spelling	➢ Lesson summary notes ➢ Date ➢ Class ➢ Topic of the day	➢ Illustrations ➢ Charts

HOW TO USE THE CHALKBOARD

1. Write from left to right, horizontally and in straight line
2. Write in uniform letters, spacing between words and lines
3. Use colored chalk to achieve variety and emphasis.
4. Do not talk when writing on the chalkboard.

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5. To avoid obstructing the learners when writing on the chalkboard, stand at an angle and use a pointer to explain work written on it.
6. Allow learners time to copy work on the chalkboard before erasing it. This may be achieved by using top-bottom rubbing cycle.
7. Write boldly and clearly to enable learners to read from all they sit at appropriate viewing positions in the classroom.
8. Clean the chalkboard after the lesson as a matter of courtesy for the next teacher.

LIMITATIONS OF CHALKBOARD

1. A lot of time is spent writing on the chalkboard instead of teaching.
2. Use of chalkboard does not cater for individual differences, especially learners with low writing speed and reading problems.
3. Use of chalkboard poses health problems such as allergies (eyes,nose)
4. Use of the chalkboard is dusty and messy and this discourages some teachers from using it effectively.
5. Very few teachers have the skills of chalkboard work or writing. This prevents them from utilizing it effectively.
6. Sometimes the size of the chalkboard delimits its effective utilization especially when it is too small.

THE ROLE OF ICT IN EDUCATION

ICT covers any product that will store, retrieve, manipulate, transmit or receive information electronically in a digital form. ICT is considered an educational medium whenever it is used to support the teaching and learning process. Examples of ICT components

- Personal and portable computers
- Data projectors
- Internet
- Interactive white boards
- CD ROMS (Compact Disk Read Only Mediums) and DVDs/VCDs
- Computer soft wares
- Video and TVs
- Magnetic tapes
- Video games
- Cameras
- The Radio and films

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A COMPUTER

It is a machine that performs calculations and processes information with a great speed and precision and holds a lot large amounts of data.

Computer Uses in Teaching and learning

- Typing information eg notes
- Storage of teaching and learning materials
- It can be used to teach processes using appropriate computer programmes eg computer animations and simulations
- Sourcing for teaching and learning materials eg from the internet if connected to the net
- Enabling distance learning to take place
- For communication of information even to long distance places
- Storage of teaching and learning materials . -
- Generating drawings and pictures that resemble photographs

Advantages of ICT integration in Classroom

- It increases learner motivation in class. ie they remain active and interested in the lesson
- Students will access and retrieve a lot of electronic information. It therefore encourages collaborate learning as students can work in groups.
- It makes learning environment more powerful. Learners can visualize problems and solutions more easily.
- The teacher can vary his/her teaching approaches and provide real life experiences.

Why ICT integration is a Challenge in Kenyan Schools Today

- Lack of ICT infrastructure in schools eg computer labs, sockets, networking, projector screens etc
- Negative attitudes held by teachers
- Lack of qualified ICT manpower. ie most teachers lack computer knowledge
- Lack of computer soft ware and computer hard wares

Computers

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A computer is a machine that manipulates, stores, processes data, and information in response to a list of instructions.

Computers can be useful in teaching and learning in the following ways;

- **Accessing new form of information**

  Traditionally learners have obtained information about a subject from either lectures or from print materials like books, journals, hand outs etc with the computers, learners can now access better current and more accurate information through the internet.

- **Enhanced audio-visual presentations**

  Teachers can supplement the traditional methods of presentation like the chalkboard, overhead transparences with modern computer based presentations using any of the several presentation software programs e.g. Microsoft's power, Adobes's persuasion etc.

- **Accessing new forms of communication**

  Teachers and learners can supplement the traditional modes of communication by doing in via the computers. For example the syllabus and the course material can be put in the internet on a website that is set up for exclusive use of students in a particular course or subject.

- **Making teaching and learning more interacting thus** promoting retention of the learnt material. This is made possible through the use of the smart board and other problem based website or webquest etc.

- **Course management programs**

  Teachers can now use course management software programs to keep track of students' progress.

- **Use of pre-packaged learning programs**

  Teachers can now design learning materials, examinations and exercise and expose them to the learners through special programs. This can be made available to learners through CD-ROM or on a website.

- **Storage of huge data**.

  Computers can be used to store, retrieve, manipulate process, transmit and receive information.

- **Enhancing interaction between the learners** and teachers and among the learners themselves and even between the learners and the larger community e.g. experts on a particular area.

Advantages of using computers

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The following are some of the advantages of using computers:

- Better and more accurate information can be accessed at will.
- They break the monotony of routine teaching
- They heighten learners' interest in learning.
- Learners and teachers can present their work in a more organized manner as they can use the computer to write, draw and print.
- Teaching and learning can be made more interactive.
- Alternative teaching approaches can be easily and conveniently implemented.
- They can store, retrieve, manipulate, process, transmit and receive information.

Disadvantages of using computers

The following are some disadvantages of using computers:

- If misused, especially the internet, learners and teachers can access wrong information.
- Learners may waste time playing computer games, thus distracting their attention.
- Learners may access other people's work and present it as their own (plagiarism) hence cheating on assignments.
- Use of computers requires that both teachers and learners be computer literate.
- Computers can be expensive to buy and maintain.
- Schools may not have access to the internet, especially those in remote areas.
- Computers may not be effectively used in areas not well served with electric power.
- Only one learner can use a computer any given time; therefore, more computers will be needed

RESOURCE PERSON

<u>Importance of resource persons</u>

- New life is breathed in the subject when learners get first-hand experience direct from the source.
- They inspire learners by making them to identify with national and international speakers or with the issues which they have presented.
- No monotony of having a lecture from same teacher .

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- Exposure to issues of importance.
- Resource people influence the future careers of these learners. After getting a lecture from prominent persons, the learners may he inspired to be like those persons.
- Use of resources people motivates the learners to learn with the hope that the resource person has something special to offer.
- They provide new information to the learners and teachers which might not be available in books. ...
- They provide interaction between the school and the wider community thus preparing the child for outside life .

Selection of a Resource Person.

- Does the resource person have something of value to share with learners? Will the person be willing to accept the invitation?
- Will the presence of the visitor disrupt school activities? If so avoid him/her.
- How is the personality of the person?
- Will he/she be able to communicate the information effectively considering the age and the language level of the learners?
- Will the speaker be able to keep time in class?
- Is the individual a controversial figure?

The procedure to follow when using a resource person/ guidelines

- Write or visit the identified resource person, introducing the intended invitation to your school. Mention about the topic, the objectives of the talk/lecture and what is expected during the talk. Interview the resource person in advance.
- Try to include questions which the learners are likely to ask so that the resource person prepares on how to respond to them.
- Talk something about the nature of the students (age. ability, level), behaviour.
- Find out if any learning resources are required and also if the class needs to be arranged in a particular way. e.g. in a circle or groups.
- Prepare the learners with questions to ask the resource person.
- Arrange time for the lesson (when the resource person will present the talk and the duration of the talk.
- Give direction to the resource person as to how to get to the school and where to
- get you in the school.-
- Meet the resource person and walk to the classroom together.

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- Introduce the resource person to the learners.
- Control the discussion between the learners and the resource person. Check on the digression and maintain discipline.
- Put down important points which might need clarification and also note any errors
- (misconception) made by the resource person for correction later.
- After the presentation invite questions from students to facilitate discussion.
- Thank the resource person for the visit/contribution.
- Make a follow-up in form of an activity.

Limitations of using a resource person.

- It is not always easy to get a reliable resource person.
- It is time-consuming: identifying, inviting and using a resource person is a long process.
- It involves extra costs because at times, one has to cater for transport, meals and Sometimes accommodation.
- The resource person involved may lack methodology of teaching.
- One might give irrelevant, distorted, exaggerated and biased information.
- During the talk/lecture the learners might not take the resource person seriously and treat the visit and talk as a form of entertainment.
- The visitor might not keep time, thus interfering with other lessons. ijj/ The resource person ma)' fail to turn up.

SOURCING FOR LEARNING RESOURCES

<u>Ways of sourcing for resources</u>

- Buying
- Improvising
- Making them using local materials
- Reproducing an original copy
- Downloading from the internet
- Recording audio resources

IMPROVISATION/ TEACHER MADE RESOURCES

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Improvisation refers to making of teaching aids to replace the real ones. Must resemble the real teaching and learning resourses.

Reasons why teachers are encouraged to improvise.(teacher made)

1. When the real resources are expensive.
2. To reduce the cost of buying since making the aids may be cheaper as materials are locally available.
3. Facilitate development of skills as learners participate in making the resources.
4. Respond to learners needs as they are made with the learners in mind.
5. Can be reviewed and evaluated on regular basis.
6. Encourage cooperation as learners may make them in groups.
7. Learners are able to appreciate the environment as it becomes useful to them.

Disadvantages/limitations /Demerits

1. They are not durable.
2. May lead to wastage of resources.
3. Time consuming as a lot of time may be taken to make them.
4. Are usually of low quality than the commercially obtained ones.

HOW TO CARE AND MAINTAIN LEARNING RESOURCES

- Cover books to avoid being torn
- Store audio materials in a flash disc for future use
- Protect computers from virus attacks
- Mount pictures and charts on the wall
- Keep print materials away from unfavorable weather conditions
- Laminating posters and pictures
- Recording them in an inventory
-

Preserving Non Projected Visuals e.g Posters, Pictures, Cartoon, Charts

- Mounting use plasticine or dry mounting use hot iron to press on the picture.
- Lamination
- Dry mounting

Procedure

- Dry the mounting board of the picture
- Place the picture on the mounting tissue, trace the outline and trim the excess tissue

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- Place clean piece of paper on the table
- Place the backing materials on the paper and Place the backing materials on the paper and make positive where the picture is mounted.
- Cover the picture with a clean piece of paper
- Apply heat using a common iron box or mounting press machine

Laminating

Advantages

- Protect Visuals
- Allows use of grease pencil or water soluble ink during instruction and can be cleaned using dump clothe e.g a Math's teacher can use a laminated picture of an orange to teach the concept of fractions.
- The fractions can be written on the lamination and rubbed after use.
- Students can be allowed to write on the lamination which is later erased.
- Books when laminated improve on durability.

Storage of visuals.

- In drawers
- Filling cabinet
- Simple cupboard
- Carton boxes
- Special room

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